



FREE 5-DAY CHALLENGE

A FREE CHALLENGE FROM LME

The Calm Mornings Challenge

Swap morning chaos for calm mornings, one small step at a time. Five days, five simple steps.

Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers

Welcome, I'm so glad you're here!

I promise you, these five days can change your mornings. I'm Renate, a Montessori educator and a mum, and I've spent over twenty years with children.

I created this challenge for you who start the day at full speed, with nagging, guilt and a knot in your stomach before eight o'clock. If you're nodding along, you are so not alone. Over the next five days we take one small step at a time, so the morning slowly becomes calmer, more predictable and a little warmer for the whole family. You don't need to turn your life upside down, just do one small thing each morning.

The five days

1. Day 1: Three things the night before
2. Day 2: One instruction at a time
3. Day 3: Ten minutes before the children
4. Day 4: A corner at child height
5. Day 5: One steady morning rhythm
6. Five-day checklist

Three Things the Night Before

Morning chaos rarely starts in the morning, it starts the night before. When a few choices are made in advance, you wake up to a morning that's already halfway there.

How to do it

Get three things ready before you go to bed.

TODAY'S STEP

- Lay out the children's clothes, and your own.
- Set the breakfast table, or as much as you can.
- Pack the bag and put it by the door.

TRY TONIGHT

Choose the three things that usually cause the most stress, and finish them before bedtime. Then the morning starts prepared, not from zero.

One Instruction at a Time

Children can't handle a long list of instructions at once. It's not defiance, it's a brain that can't hold it all. One thing at a time brings calm for both of you.

How to do it

Give one message, and wait.

TODAY'S STEP

- Give one instruction: "Put your socks on."
- Wait until it's done, without adding more.
- Then give the next one, calm and clear.

TRY TODAY

Count how many times you usually repeat yourself. Today, give one thing at a time instead. Fewer instructions mean less nagging, and more cooperation.

Ten Minutes Before the Children

A calm mother makes for a calmer morning. Ten minutes alone before the house wakes up changes the whole tone of the home, because the children feel your calm.

How to do it

Take ten minutes just for yourself.

TODAY'S STEP

- Get up ten minutes before the children.
- Sit with a cup of coffee or tea, in quiet.
- Just breathe, before the day begins.

TRY TOMORROW

Set the alarm ten minutes earlier, and spend them on yourself, not your phone. This isn't selfish, it's the foundation of a calm morning.

A Corner at Child Height

Children help when they're allowed to and when it's possible. One small change in the hallway lets your child get dressed alone, instead of waiting for you.

How to do it

Get the hallway ready for your child.

TODAY'S STEP

- Put up a hook at child height.
- Place the shoes where your child can reach them.
- Give the outdoor clothes a fixed spot.

TRY TODAY

Crouch down and see the hallway through your child's eyes. Move one thing down to child height, and let your child do it themselves tomorrow.

One Steady Morning Rhythm

It's not the child that's difficult, it's the morning that lacks anchors. The same order every day gives security, and secure children cooperate.

How to do it

Create one steady order.

TODAY'S STEP

- Choose an order: up, toilet, clothes, breakfast, teeth, shoes.
- Do the same things in the same order every morning.
- Put the order up with pictures, at child height.

TRY ALL WEEK

Children love predictability. When the morning always follows the same track, you need to nag less, because the children know what's coming.

CHECKLIST

Five-day checklist

Tick off each day you try. Remember: done is better than perfect.

This week

- ✓ Day 1: Three things the night before
- ✓ Day 2: One instruction at a time
- ✓ Day 3: Ten minutes before the children
- ✓ Day 4: A corner at child height
- ✓ Day 5: One steady morning rhythm

Congratulations, you've just given your family five calmer mornings! Did this help? This is only the beginning. Calm mornings are one of five steps in the BLOOM Method, my signature course, where we create calm throughout the whole day, together. If you'd like to go further, you'll find me at @lmexplorers and in LME.



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